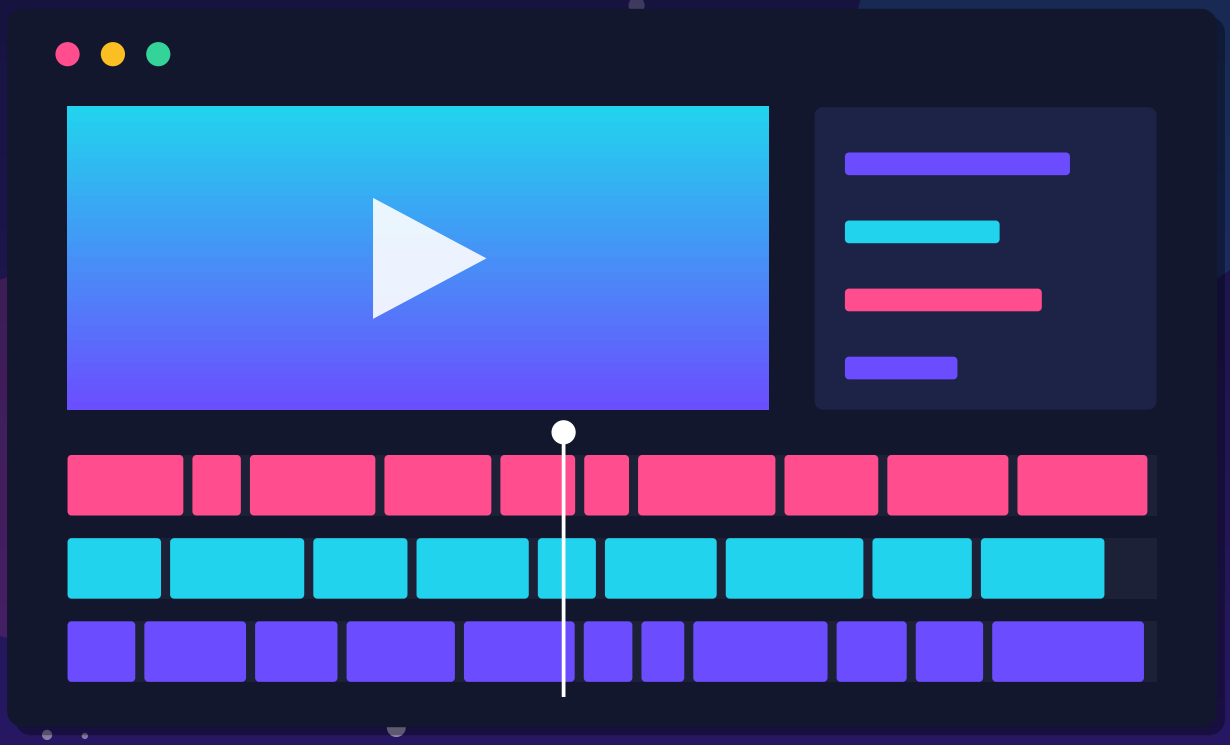

Video Editing with AI

A beginner's guide to editing, audio, colour, motion graphics and AI-powered workflows

BASIC EXPLANATION | 6 TOPICS | EDITING BASICS TO AI WORKFLOW

CONTENTS

What you will learn

Video editing is the craft of shaping raw footage into a clear, engaging story. AI now speeds up the repetitive parts (captions, cleanup, resizing) so you can spend more time on creative decisions. This guide walks through six topics, from the foundations to a modern AI-assisted workflow.

01 **Editing Basics**
Timeline, cuts, pacing, shot types, storytelling

02 **Premiere Pro or DaVinci Resolve**
Project setup, trimming, transitions, export

03 **Audio and Music**
Noise removal, mixing, voiceovers, sound design

04 **Colour and Titles**
Colour correction, grading, motion titles

05 **Motion Graphics Basics**
Keyframes, masks, simple animation, templates

06 **AI Editing Workflow**
Auto captions, AI voice, background removal, content repurposing

SECTION 01

Editing Basics

Every editor, whatever the software, works with the same building blocks. Learn these first and every tool becomes easier.

Timeline	The workspace where clips are arranged in time. Video sits on V tracks, sound on A tracks, and you read it left to right.
Cuts	The point where one clip changes to another. Common types: straight cut, J-cut (audio leads the picture), L-cut (audio trails), and jump cut.
Pacing	The rhythm of the edit. Fast cuts create energy; longer shots create calm or tension. Match pace to the mood and platform.
Shot types	Wide (setting), medium (action), close-up (emotion), B-roll (supporting visuals that cover cuts and add context).
Storytelling	A clear beginning, middle and end. Hook the viewer early, build interest, then deliver a payoff or call to action.

Key points

- Cut on action so movement flows smoothly between shots.
- Trim dead air: start late, leave early.
- Vary shot sizes to keep the viewer visually engaged.
- Every shot should have a reason to be there. If it does not move the story, remove it.

Beginner tip

Watch your first cut with the sound off. If the story still makes sense visually, your structure is strong.

SECTION 02

Premiere Pro or DaVinci Resolve

Both are professional editors. Premiere Pro (Adobe, subscription) integrates tightly with After Effects and Photoshop. DaVinci Resolve (Blackmagic) has a capable free version and is famous for colour grading. The core workflow is nearly identical.

Project setup	Create a project, import media, organise into bins/folders, then create a sequence that matches your footage (resolution and frame rate, e.g. 1920x1080 at 24 or 30 fps).
Trimming	Use the razor/blade tool to split clips, ripple delete to close gaps, and drag clip edges to adjust length. Shortcuts speed this up greatly.
Transitions	Cross dissolves and dips soften changes of time or place. Use sparingly; a plain cut is usually best.
Export	Choose H.264 (MP4) for web and social. Match the sequence settings, pick a sensible bitrate, and preview the file before sharing.

Key points

- Premiere Pro: Project panel, Source/Program monitors, Timeline, Essential Graphics.
- DaVinci Resolve: separate pages for Cut, Edit, Color, Fusion, Fairlight (audio) and Deliver.
- Beginners often start in Resolve's Cut page for fast, simple assembly.
- Save often and keep original media in one organised folder.

Useful shortcuts (Premiere)

- **C** blade tool, **V** selection tool, **Space** play/pause.
- **Ctrl/Cmd + K** splits at the playhead, **Shift + Delete** ripple deletes.

Which should you pick?
If you want a free, all-in-one tool with excellent colour, start with DaVinci Resolve. If you work with Adobe apps already, choose Premiere Pro.

SECTION 03

Audio and Music

Viewers forgive average visuals far more easily than bad sound. Clean, balanced audio makes a video feel professional.

Noise removal	Reduce hiss, hum and room noise with denoise and de-hum effects, or AI tools such as Adobe Enhance Speech and Resolve's Voice Isolation.
Mixing	Balance dialogue, music and effects. Dialogue should peak around -12 to -6 dB; music sits lower underneath. Use keyframes or 'ducking' to dip music while someone speaks.
Voiceovers	Record in a quiet, soft room (blankets help), keep the mic a hand-width away, and use a pop filter. Record a few seconds of room tone.
Sound design	Add whooshes, hits, ambience and foley to give weight to motion and transitions. Layer small sounds for realism.

Key points

- Always use royalty-free or licensed music to avoid copyright claims.
- Add short audio fades to stop clicks and pops at cuts.
- Check your mix on headphones and on a phone speaker.
- Normalise loudness for the platform (around -14 LUFS for most online video).

Remember
Audio is half of the experience. Fix sound problems before colour or effects.

SECTION 04

Colour and Titles

Colour sets mood and keeps shots consistent. Titles communicate information and reinforce your brand.

Colour correction	Fix technical issues first: exposure, white balance, contrast and saturation so skin looks natural and shots match each other.
Colour grading	Apply a creative look on top: warm and golden for nostalgia, teal and orange for cinematic feel, desaturated for drama. LUTs offer quick starting points.
Motion titles	Animated text such as lower thirds, intros and kinetic typography. Animate position, scale and opacity with easing for a smooth, polished result.

Key points

- Use scopes (waveform, vectorscope) rather than trusting your eyes alone.
- Correct one clip, then copy the settings to similar shots.
- Choose one or two fonts only, with strong contrast against the background.
- Keep titles inside safe margins and on screen long enough to be read twice.

Workflow order

1. Correct 2. Match shots 3. Grade for style 4. Add titles on top.

SECTION 05

Motion Graphics Basics

Motion graphics bring text, shapes and icons to life. A few core ideas cover most simple animations.

Keyframes	Markers that record a property (position, scale, rotation, opacity) at a point in time. The software fills in the movement between them.
Masks	Shapes that reveal or hide part of a layer. Use them for reveals, spotlighting, text wipes or isolating a subject.
Simple animation	Combine keyframes with easing (ease in/out) so movement feels natural. Start with slide, fade and scale-in effects.
Templates	Ready-made motion graphics (MOGRTs in Premiere, Fusion/title templates in Resolve) you customise with your own text and colours.

Key points

- Fewer, cleaner animations look more professional than many busy ones.
- Right-click keyframes to apply easing for natural acceleration.
- Keep timing consistent so your graphics feel like one family.
- Save your own favourite animations as reusable presets.

Try this first

Animate a text title: fade opacity from 0 to 100 while sliding up 40 pixels over half a second, with ease out.

SECTION 06

AI Editing Workflow

AI does not replace editing skill. It removes repetitive work so you can move faster and focus on story and style.

Auto captions	AI transcribes speech and creates timed subtitles in minutes (Premiere speech-to-text, Resolve transcription, CapCut). Always proofread names and technical words.
AI voice	Text-to-speech or voice-cloning tools (e.g. ElevenLabs) generate narration or fix a missed line. Use only voices you have the right to use, and disclose where appropriate.
Background removal	AI masking tools (Resolve Magic Mask, Premiere Roto Brush, CapCut) cut out a subject without a green screen.
Content repurposing	AI finds highlights in long videos and reformats them into vertical shorts and reels, with auto-reframing, captions and different aspect ratios.

Key points

- Text-based editing: edit video by deleting words in the transcript.
- Auto-remove silences and filler words to tighten pacing.
- AI upscaling, denoise and speech enhancement rescue imperfect footage.
- Always review AI output. It can make errors in words, cutouts and edit choices.

Repurposing one video into many

- One long video becomes 3 to 5 vertical clips, a square teaser and an audio-only version.
- Reuse the transcript for a blog post, description and social captions.

A simple AI workflow
Record > Auto-transcribe > Cut by text > Clean audio > Add captions > Export in several formats for each platform.

Final thought

Master the basics first: story, pacing, clean sound and tidy colour. Then let AI handle the time-consuming tasks. The best results come from human creative judgement combined with smart automation.